

THE TORRENT QUICKSTART

Games set in the Torrent are heavily based on heists and other clandestine missions called Gigs, and on the criminal connections players form while pulling them off.

The player characters are referred to as Operators, working together in a crew. Each Gig should be an opportunity for the Digital MasterMind (DMM) to build an overarching narrative by tying in the Operators' existing connections or introducing them to new characters or organizations that will come back later. For the players, a Gig should be an opportunity to leverage existing connections to their advantage or form new ones to benefit them in the future.

CHARACTER CREATION QUICK REFERENCE	
Total Skill Ranks:	14
Skill Ranks from Background:	3
Skill Ranks from Occupation:	3
Skill Ranks from Free Allocation:	8
Trait Scores:	(Ranks/2)+1
Speed:	5+Cool
Stability Points:	7+Humanity
Stability Levels:	2
Firewall:	10+Intellect
Fatigue Limit:	3
RAM:	12
Hardware Slots:	4
Avatar Abilities:	2
Software:	3
Hardware:	1
Allies:	1
Enemies:	1
Debts:	2

The Torrent uses a highly flexible ability and equipment system. There are no classes or levels. Instead, players can mix and match to find a unique playstyle. Players can gain additional abilities when they reach a milestone, determined by the DMM.

The setting is a satirical and whimsical setting riffing off of online spaces and games. Because of this, characters, locations, and storylines in this setting can include almost anything– A weapons-dealing taco truck staffed entirely by Hatsune Miku clones, for instance.

CHARACTER CREATION

Step 1: Stats

Several steps in character creation require adding ranks to your character's skills. Characters in Ther Torrent have 16 skills that represent their proficiency in performing various tasks. The number of ranks in that skill determines the number of dice you roll when making a skill check. In addition, each character has 3 traits: Cool, Humanity, and Intellect. Each skill is related to one of these traits.

The 16 skills listed under their related traits are as follows:

Cool: Represents one's ability to stay calm under pressure and take control of situations.

- **Aura**: Intimidation and awe.
- **Conceal**: Stealth and sleight of hand.
- **Aware**: Passive perception and attention to detail.
- **Deceive**: Verbal misdirection and cunning.
- **Perform**: Acting and music.
- **Reflex**: Swiftness and reaction time.

Humanity: Represents one's willpower and connection to their human nature.

- **Appearance**: Disguise and seduction.
- **Converse**: Persuasion and eloquence.
- **Insight**: Emotional intelligence and natural intuition.
- **Inspire**: Motivation and agitation.
- **Resist**: Determination and willpower.
- **Soothe**: De-escalation and pacification.

Intellect: Represents one's ability to take in information and solve complex problems.

- **Debug**: Exploitation and manipulation of software.
- **Decipher**: Decryption and deduction.
- **Interface**: Interact with complex systems and tools.
- **Know**: Recollection and connections.
- **Program**: Creating and modifying software.
- **Search**: Tracking and locating hidden things.

STEP 1 :: BACKGROUNDS & OCCUPATIONS

The first step in creating a character is to choose a background and occupation from their respective tables. Each background and occupation comes with an amount of starting currency (Torrum) and a list of 5 skills. You may allocate 3 skill ranks each between the skills provided by your background and occupation.

You should also come up with one ally and one debt related to your background, and one enemy and one debt related to your occupation. Allies, enemies, and debts should be an individual or organization that can act as a plot hook for the DMM or as an asset you can call on for help. Debts may be monetary or more abstract, like a debt of gratitude, and the person or organization that holds the debt is more important than what is owed.

By the end of this step, your character should have 6 total skill ranks, some amount of Torrum, an ally, 2 debts, and an enemy.

STEP 2 :: SKILL RANK ALLOCATION

In addition to the 6 skill ranks granted by your background and occupation, you may allocate 8 ranks freely between the skills on your character sheet. Once this step is done, your character should have 14 total skill ranks. Remember that no skill may exceed 3 ranks during the character creation process.

After allocating skill ranks, there are several stats derived from your skills. Each of your **trait scores**, Cool, Humanity, and Intellect, can be calculated by counting the total number of ranks in its related skills, dividing by 2 (rounded up), and adding 1. Your Trait points start out equal to your trait scores.

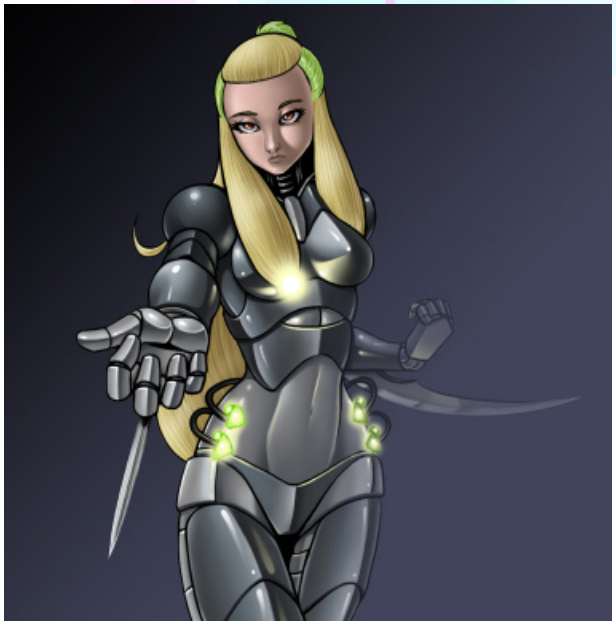
Your speed, stability points, and firewall are derived from your trait scores. Your Speed is equal to 5 + Cool. Your Stability Points are equal to 7 + Humanity. Your Firewall is equal to 10 + Intellect.

Finally, there are several stats that start off at a static value. Your Fatigue Limit is 3, you have 12 RAM, and you have 4 Hardware Slots.

STEP 4 :: GEAR & ABILITIES

HDL

Paragon uses the HDL, or "half die level," system for all rolls. Any HDL is a die roll whose maximum is twice the HDL number, using the lowest number of dice with the most similar number of sides. Any roll or check is made using an HDL equal to the applicable stat for the task, plus the character's skill rating, adjusted by any conditional modifiers. The following table summarizes com-



mon HDL rolls for most tasks, showing the rolls for HDL 1 through 10. Typically, characters are limited to stats of 10 or lower, meaning HDL doesn't usually exceed 10. However, by spending Energy, and also using settings in which characters can exceed normal human limits, HDL has no upper limit.

Energy

One of the key features of the Paragon system is Energy, representing a number of factors enabling characters to exceed their normal limits in many regards. Energy can be used to approximate adrenaline, exceptional effort, and even supernatural power.

Experience and Character Improvement

Paragon has no classes or levels. Instead, experience points earned in game are spent to directly increase skills and stats, or to purchase Backgrounds or buy off Weaknesses. EXP can also be used for a number of other purposes, including providing bonuses to actions or forcing enemies to re-roll.

Active Delay Combat System

Combat in the Paragon system is turn-based, but uses a floating system based on individual reaction times and the complexity of actions being taken. This system, known as the Active Delay combat system, is highly dynamic, captures the urgency of combat, and also demonstrates the dangers of being outnumbered. If a combatant is too busy defending himself from multiple opponents, he'll have a hard time effectively fighting back.

As a note, the Paragon system is a role-playing system, and the realism approximated makes combat quite deadly. The combat rules are extensive, but by no means is Paragon meant to be a strictly combat-oriented game. Characters throwing themselves blindly into combat, a typical tactic in many traditional role-playing games, will quickly find themselves at risk of death or serious injury.

Game Cards

Another key feature of the Paragon system is the game cards, which are integral to the Paragon experience, and the system has been designed in such a way as to function best in conjunction with them. Since combat is so lethal, many cards are the only way players can survive. They also have additional effects, such as providing bonus EXP, improving rolls, or even introducing role-playing situations.

Other Features

The main Paragon book also includes complete rules for cybernetics, a bestiary, an original magic system, and guidelines for Narrators.



The Paragon system is intended to be both intuitive and realistic, based on the philosophy "if it makes sense, do it that way." While the book contains extensive rules for many situations, the simplest and most sensible approach should always be taken in any game. The rules are guidelines meant to promote flow and fairness, but ultimately any Narrator should adapt the system and rules to suit their own game and players.

Other Settings

The Paragon system is a universal system, separate from any specific setting or world. Tremorworks also has released, or will be releasing, additional settings to add worlds, character options, skills, and much more. Existing and planned settings include:

LUCID: Dreamscape Reality

LUCID throws players into a world much like our own, in which Dreamers are able to not only control their own lucid dreams, but also enter reality and control it as if it were a dream. LUCID introduces several dream-based game mechanics, as well as terrifyingly nightmarish Shadows, creatures bent on the destruction of Dreamers at all costs.

Perfect Horizon 216X

This follow-up to the original Perfect Horizon cyberpop setting expands on the original world, one rife with political and economic espionage, uncontrolled genetic engineering, cybernetics and mecha. It introduces a slew of new technology, as well as options for players to create cyborgs, chimera, Neutopes and Terraformers.

Demongate High Second Edition

Enter a high school where the supernaturally gifted are trained to use their powers to protect humanity from the demonic threat lurking just beneath it. This massive update to the original Demongate High, clocking in at over 500 pages, greatly expands on the modern fantasy setting, adding ten new playable archetypes, over a hundred demons, dozens of terrestrial creatures, and a complete list of angels and celestial beings, as well as extensive rules for powers and new skills, detailed information on the various dimensions, and two complete introductory adventures.

The Embers of Pyre

Continuing the story of Demongate High, The Embers of Pyre mixes high fantasy, magic, and supernatural elements with futuristic lost technology. It includes 50+ playable races, ranging from humans and angelic elves to minotaurs, phoenixes, and even robotic Remnants; 220+ spells, 130+ monsters and other creatures, and a fully-realized world complete with politics and economies and a host of new options for magicians.

Infinite Vector

This deep space science fiction setting expands on the Perfect Horizon timeline, propelling it several hundred years further into the future to a time when humanity has reached the stars. As part of alien races, some famil rre, players delve into a g includes rules for dc gy, guidelines for des ed rules for starship co

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